



Management Plan 2023

DIRECTORATE-GENERAL FOR
DEFENCE INDUSTRY AND SPACE

Contents

Introduction.....	3
PART 1. Delivering on the Commission's priorities: main outputs for 2023	6
A. A European Green Deal.....	6
B. A Europe fit for the digital age	8
C. A stronger Europe in the world	15
D. Promoting our European way of life	19
PART 2. Modernising the administration: main outputs for 2023.....	23
A. Human resource management	23
B. Sound financial management	24
C. Fraud risk management	25
D. Digital transformation and information management.....	26
E. Sound environmental management.....	28
F. Initiatives to improve economy and efficiency of financial and non-financial activities	28
G. Security and Information	29
Annex 1 – DG DEFIS performance tables	30

Introduction

DG Defence Industry and Space: Making the EU more secure, sustainable and resilient

The Directorate-General for Defence Industry and Space (DG DEFIS) develops and carries out the Commission's policies on defence industry and space. Following Russia's unprovoked and unjustified military aggression against Ukraine, EU action in the field of security and defence is more urgent than ever. DG DEFIS will put forward proposals and effort into reinforcing the **resilience** and **strategic autonomy** of the EU.

This **annual DG DEFIS Management Plan** outlines the key deliverables for 2023, in line with DG DEFIS' strategic plan and intervention logic (see graph on page 5) for the period 2020-2024. The outputs contribute to the political priorities of the von der Leyen Commission 'A European Green Deal', 'A Europe fit for the digital age', 'A stronger Europe in the world' and 'Promoting our European way of life'.

The main priorities of DG DEFIS for 2023 will be the following:

A stronger Europe in the world

- achieve adoption by the co-legislators of the short-term emergency measure and priority pending proposal for a **European Defence Industry Reinforcement through common Procurement Act (EDIRPA)** and propose a more structural long-term EU approach through a **European Defence Investment Programme (EDIP) Regulation**;
- deliver an  ⁽¹⁾ **EU Space Strategy for Security and Defence**, as set out in the 2023 Commission Work Programme;
- continue the implementation of the **European Defence Fund (EDF)**, the European Defence Industrial Development Programme (EDIDP) and the Preparatory Action on Defence Research (PADR), as well as the **EU Defence Innovation Scheme (EUDIS)**;
- improve and accelerate **Military Mobility** within and beyond the EU;

A Europe fit for the digital age

- roll out the implementation of **IRIS²** (Infrastructure for Resilience, Interconnectivity and Security by Satellite) following the adoption early 2023 of the **Regulation establishing the Union Secure Connectivity Programme**;

⁽¹⁾ The icon  refers to initiatives featured in annexes I and II of the 2023 Commission work programme.

- continue the implementation of the **EU Space Programme**, in particular the **second generation of Galileo** and the development of **Copernicus services for governmental use**;
- continue the implementation of Horizon Europe for the space part ⁽²⁾, and of the **Space Entrepreneurship Initiative CASSINI**, via the respective work programmes;
- deliver on the EU's updated industrial strategy by setting out a green, digital and resilient **transition pathway for the aerospace and defence ecosystem**;
- deliver a comprehensive strategy for supporting the **uptake of EU space services**;

A European Green Deal

- ensure that the **Alliance for Zero-Emission Aviation** delivers on a shared ambition to achieve the fastest possible market uptake of fully decarbonised flights;
- continue supporting the European Green Deal through **Copernicus, the EU's Earth observation system**;

Modernising the administration

- continue exploring new ways of working by setting up **thematic taskforces** and pooling relevant expertise within DG DEFIS directorates and units on priority topics i.e. on secure connectivity, skills, critical raw materials and the development of Copernicus services for governmental use.

The main challenges in the context of 2023 are:

- to deliver on DG DEFIS' priorities against an evolving geo-political instability, which impact activities and workload;
- to strengthen the resilience of the EU aerospace and defence supply chains, e.g. by reducing technological non-EU dependencies;
- to add the 'European Year of Skills' dimension to DG DEFIS activities, as announced by President von der Leyen in her State of the Union (SOTEU) 2022 address;
- to defend democracy and EU values through overall coordination and mainstreaming of the Commission activities to counter hybrid threats;
- to strengthen the EU's resilience to respond to increasing cyberattacks targeting military and civilian critical infrastructure in the EU.

⁽²⁾ Horizon Europe Cluster 4: 'Digital, Industry and Space'.

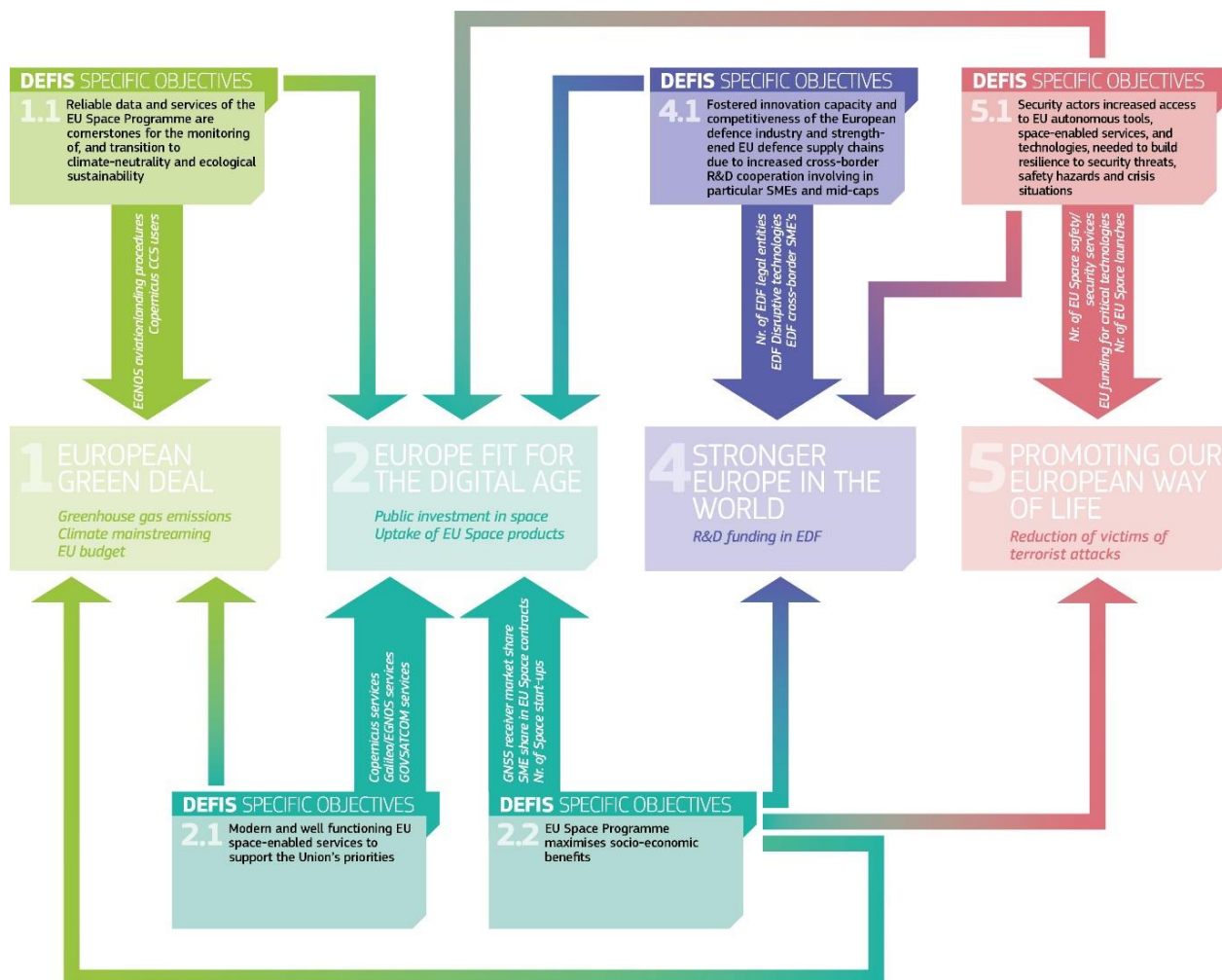


Figure 1 – DG DEFIS intervention logic

Source: DG DEFIS Strategic plan for 2020 -2024

PART 1. Delivering on the Commission's priorities: main outputs for 2023

The Commission's ambition for **greener and sustainable, more digital and connected, resilient societies** is at the core of DG DEFIS' plans. Likewise, **reinforcing strategic autonomy** and **security in Europe**, whilst fostering a spirit of **international cooperation and maintaining core democratic values**, underpins DG DEFIS' mission. In this section, DG DEFIS' contributions to four of the von der Leyen Commission headline ambitions are set out in more detail. Cross-cutting activities contributing to several headlines, and expected to deliver beyond the set out specific objectives, are presented under the sub-sections 'other important initiatives'. Relevant performance tables can be found in the Annex.

A. A European Green Deal

Specific objective 1.1: Reliable data and services of the EU Space Programme are cornerstones for the monitoring of, and transition to, climate-neutrality and ecological sustainability

DG DEFIS proactively targets legislative initiatives under the Green Deal, as presented in the Commission's 2023 work programme, to ensure the contribution of the EU Space Programme to EU cross-sectoral strategies. For example, **Copernicus** ⁽³⁾, **the EU's Earth observation system**, contributes directly to the Commission's ambitions on fighting climate change with its unique capability to **monitor greenhouse gas emissions**. It also contributes to the implementation and monitoring of EU initiatives such as the EU Biodiversity Strategy 2030, the EU Digital Twin Ocean ⁽⁴⁾ or the reporting in the context of the Land Use, Land Use Change and Forestry (LULUCF) Regulation.

Copernicus services' data are used by international bodies to track trends towards achieving the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)**, to feed into various reports (e.g. the EUROSTAT SDG reporting) and to support the implementation of initiatives such as the 'UN decade collaborative centre on ocean prediction'. In 2023, the Copernicus **European State of the Climate Report** and the **Ocean State Report** will be issued, peer-reviewed by established international experts.

DG DEFIS will continue contributing to **'Destination Earth (DestinE)'** ⁽⁵⁾, which kicked off in 2022 with the aim of being fully developed in 2023-2024. This flagship is run by the DG for Communications Networks, Content and Technology (CNECT) and is expected to become

⁽³⁾ Copernicus is the European Union's flagship Earth observation programme which operates through six thematic services: Atmosphere, Marine, Land, Climate Change, Security and Emergency. More info: <https://www.copernicus.eu/en/copernicus-services>.

⁽⁴⁾ Initiative implemented in cooperation with DG RTD, DG MARE and DG CNECT.

⁽⁵⁾ Part of the Digital Europe Programme.

a powerful tool to guide the green transition. DestinE aims to develop a digital multi-dimensional replica of the Earth system and will allow for the further exploitation of Copernicus Earth observation data and information products through artificial intelligence and advanced high-performance computing. In 2023, Copernicus and DestinE will set out an implementation roadmap to cross-fertilise data management platforms and define a complementary portfolio of environmental services.

The EU satellite navigation services provided by **Galileo** and the European Geostationary Navigation Overlay Service (**EGNOS**) lead to a range of innovative applications in support of the Green Deal objectives, such as applications on smart mobility and on multi-mode transport digitalisation with **optimised travel routes**, allowing for a reduction of CO₂ emissions.

A project - launched in 2021 - to address the **environmental impacts of the EU Space Programme** is planned to start its second phase in 2023 for two years, to develop the lifecycle assessment category rules for the space value chain. In addition, a pilot '**study for high-cadence monitoring for the EU Green Deal**' will be launched in 2023 and will identify complementarities between Copernicus and existing and new (space) commercial capabilities to support the monitoring of the EU Green Deal and EU environmental policies. It will also analyse potential future innovative solutions where Copernicus could support and complement environmental and climate policy development.

Other important initiatives

There are other important initiatives within the portfolio of DG DEFIS which support the European Green Deal and **the transition to climate-neutrality**.



Being responsible for civil aeronautics, DG DEFIS will continue animating and supporting the work of the **Alliance on Zero-Emission Aviation (AZEA)** to prepare the **market take-up of hydrogen and battery-electric aircraft**, encouraging the aeronautics industry on a path towards the EU's climate neutrality objective and sustainable growth. AZEA is set to agree in 2023 on a target scenario for the deployment of zero-emission aircraft which will serve to focus the analytical work and recommendations of the Alliance's working groups and to set up a pipeline of projects and financing opportunities.

Furthermore, three projects will be launched in 2023 under the European Defence Fund (EDF) for **defence-oriented solutions contributing to climate, energy management and efficiency**, with a budget of EUR 84 million. DG DEFIS will also evaluate proposals – and in due time prepare the launch of projects – submitted under the EDF work programme 2022 under the topic 'Sustainable components for underwater applications', which has an indicative budget of EUR 20 million. In addition, the EDF work programme 2023 is expected to include topics related to energy resilience and environmental transition.

DG DEFIS, together with the Secretariat-General (SG), the DG for Climate Action (CLIMA), the DG for Energy (ENER), the European External Action Service (EEAS) and the European Defence Agency (EDA), will contribute to the work on the **Joint Communication on Climate, Defence and Security** expected to be adopted in the first semester of 2023.

Communication

DG DEFIS will continue to set up partnerships with cities across the world to showcase the travelling exhibition [*Space for Our Planet*](#). This is a multimedia exhibition with testimonies of users benefiting from EU Space data and services, showing how space technologies contribute to the attainment of the UN SDG.

DG DEFIS will also continue to set-up partnerships with schools to organise info sessions raising awareness of the EU Space Programme and the role of EU Space data in their daily lives, and notably to mitigate the impact of climate change.

In spring 2023, a high-level conference will be organised under the auspices of the Swedish Presidency of the Council of the EU on the benefits of 'EU Space for the Planet' to mark the 25th anniversary of Copernicus.

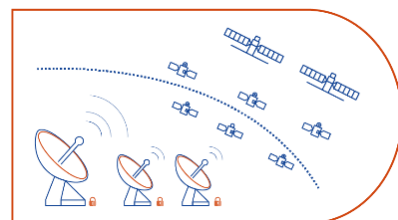
Social media presence (e.g. on Twitter, Instagram and Facebook) will be continued and upscaled as appropriate to complement all planned communication activities ⁽⁶⁾ and to actively engage with stakeholders and citizens. The fight against disinformation remains at the heart of all communication activities. Dedicated social media campaigns will be launched to counter disinformation and raise awareness about the state of our Planet based on reliable data.

B. A Europe fit for the digital age

Specific objective 2.1: Modern and well-functioning EU space-enabled services to support the Union's priorities

New flagship - EU space-based global secure connectivity system - IRIS²

On 15 February 2022, the European Commission presented a proposal for a Regulation establishing the **Union Secure Connectivity Programme** ⁽⁷⁾. The programme aims at deploying an EU satellite constellation: '**IRIS²**' (Infrastructure for Resilience, Interconnectivity and Security by Satellite). Co-legislators achieved a political agreement on 17 November 2022; the regulation is expected

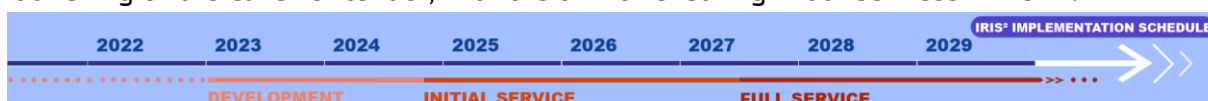


⁽⁶⁾ This applies to all communication activities that are presented in other sections in this document.

⁽⁷⁾ This initiative was listed under the 2022 Commission work programme (annex 1), in the Joint Declaration on EU legislative priorities for 2022 (action #60) and as a key EU legislative priority under the 2023 Commission work programme (annex 3).

to be adopted in the plenary of the European Parliament in early 2023. IRIS² is Europe's reply to the growing geopolitical instability and cybersecurity threats. Its aim is to strengthen Europe's strategic autonomy, technological leadership and geopolitical influence, including in the Arctic and Africa.

The Programme is responding to successive Council conclusions ⁽⁸⁾ and related European citizens' calls in the context of the Conference on the Future of Europe calling for fast, affordable, secure and stable internet access everywhere in the EU. It will boost the competitiveness of the EU industry, including small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) and start-ups, in the field of satellite communication solutions and services, by spearheading innovation to ensure that technological advances and their governmental use act as a driver of innovation and wider commercialisation. In 2023, efforts will focus on the implementation of the Programme by adopting the necessary implementing acts and launching of the calls for tender, with the aim of ensuring initial services in 2024.



EU Space Programme

DG DEFIS will continue to manage the implementation of the EU Space Programme, which is the cornerstone of the EU space policy. The programme aims to maintain and constantly modernise the EU's space infrastructures, while further developing services provided in line with user expectations and political needs. With a novel biennial approach to provide better visibility on longer term plans to stakeholders, the **2023-2024 work programmes of the EU Space Programme** are setting out the detailed objectives, activities and budget spending plans by EU space component (Copernicus, Galileo/EGNOS, GOVSATCOM, Space Situational Awareness (SSA) and horizontal).

In 2023, DG DEFIS will launch two studies to exploit synergies between the space and defence sector: (i) a study on synergies between the EDF and space policy and (ii) a feasibility study to support the implementation of the EU Space Strategy for Security and Defence. The EU Space Regulation requires a **mid-term evaluation** of the implementation of the programme by June 2024. To this end, a study will be launched in 2023 to perform the cost-benefit analysis. The conclusions of the evaluation will be reported to the European Parliament and Council, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions.

The speedy **implementation of the second generation of Galileo** is fundamental to keep the EU's sovereign global navigation satellite system (GNSS) at the forefront in the current geopolitical context. This work will continue in 2023, with the aim to deliver initial services of **Galileo Public Regulated Service (PRS)** for government users and to achieve **full operational capability of the Galileo Open Service in 2024**.

⁽⁸⁾ [EEAS\(2017\) 359](#), [EUCO 1/19](#), [EUCO 13/20](#), [9163/21](#)

New Galileo services include **authentication and increase of positioning accuracy to the level of two decimetres**: the Galileo Open Service Navigation Message Authentication (OSNMA) will continue its public observation phase offering an initial signal capability and the Galileo High Accuracy Service (HAS) will offer initial services in 2023.

Several new technical inventions developed under the Galileo Programme have the potential of improving speed, accuracy and robustness of Galileo services. To obtain an enforceable intellectual property rights (IPR) for the Union, DG DEFIS seeks protection of the inventions by filing applications for **patent protection**.

In 2023, DG DEFIS, with the technical support of the European Space Agency (ESA), will prepare the **future Copernicus satellite constellation, in particular the options for hybrid constellations** and the development of new Earth observation capacities (Copernicus expansion missions), notably the **Copernicus CO₂ monitoring mission** in support of the **anthropogenic CO₂ monitoring and verification support capacity**. New innovative and secure **Copernicus Earth observation services for governmental use** are under consideration to strengthen resilience. These services would provide timely, fully reliable and continuously available Earth observation capabilities and respond to the EU and Member States' government needs.

The Commission will continue to work closely with Member States in relevant radio frequency regulatory fora to ensure the appropriate radio spectrum access for the EU Space Programme and to identify and mitigate the risk of any negative interference impacts. DG DEFIS will ensure its presence at the 2023 World Radiocommunication Conference.

Capitalising on European cloud services, Copernicus will simplify user access to its large volumes of high-quality data and information through two overarching data access services. This extensive upgrade is part of an **Integrated Data Management strategy** seeking to strengthen Copernicus as a 'system of systems' and empower users with improved data access and analytics. This strategy will be shared with 'DestinE' to ease the systems convergence, interoperability and seamless user journey when exploring and exploiting EU funded environmental and digital services.

Communication

Activities will focus on **building confidence** on the high quality of the EU space-based services. A dedicated campaign will be organised to promote IRIS². Targeting a wider audience, DG DEFIS will promote opportunities for developing new applications based on space data and services in new 'non-space' sectors.

Specific objective 2.2: EU Space Programme maximises socio-economic benefits

Framework conditions for market uptake

In 2023, DG DEFIS will continue **promoting the use of space data, information and services in EU policies and legislation**, in particular in the initiatives proposed in the Commission work programme 2023 and through the 'Knowledge Centre for Earth Observation'.

Addressing the recommendations of the European Court of Auditor's Special Report 07/2021 on the effectiveness of the measures taken by the Commission to promote the uptake of services derived from the EU space components, **a comprehensive strategy for supporting the uptake of EU space services** in the EU will be released in 2023.

DG DEFIS is committed to supporting the Commissions' ambitions on equality and is **mainstreaming equality across defence, aeronautics and space policies**. Building on a 2021 pan-European study to map the status quo and a 2022 study for the collection of baseline data, DG DEFIS will continue to actively promote the European values of equality, diversity and inclusion in the defence and space sectors in 2023.

Research and innovation – Horizon Europe⁹

Under the lead of DG DEFIS, the Health and Digital Executive Agency (HaDEA), the European Union Agency for the Space Programme (EUSPA) and ESA are implementing projects under the Horizon Europe 2021-2022 work programme to foster the development of innovative and competitive European upstream and downstream space sectors. Priority actions in 2023 will focus on developing:

- critical technologies reinforcing the European autonomous access to space and in the field of quantum communication;
- technological solutions for the components of the Space Programme;
- R&D activities for the Secure Connectivity Programme;
- pathfinder missions, i.e. on-orbit servicing and quantum space gravimetry.

DG DEFIS will start preparing **a strategy for space research and innovation** to identify areas for future action and to support the programming activities for the period 2025-2027. In addition, a **space partnership** will be put in place in 2023, which will be instrumental for preparing technological roadmaps in future priority areas for space research. Focusing on new space solutions, services and technologies, the partnership will bring together industry, academia, and research and technology organisations.

⁽⁹⁾ To be noted, research and innovation activities go beyond the reach of specific objective 2.2 that is seeking to maximise socio-economic benefits under the EU Space Programme and form an integral part of the EU Space Programme and the EDF managed by DG DEFIS.

Supporting European space-based businesses & New Space

To create a dynamic European New Space industry, the Commission's **Space Entrepreneurship Initiative CASSINI** will be further developed and include actions to boost entrepreneurship, improve networks and business skills in 2021-2027, notably to:

		
• Facilitate access to finance for growing companies with intensification of efforts in signing investment agreements with the European Investment Fund (EIF) and with Venture Capital Funds and improve access to loans through close cooperation with the European Investment Bank (EIB) and commercial banks. This also includes outreach activities targeted at new groups of investors and institutional investors through capacity building;	• Launch the CASSINI Business Accelerator in the first quarter of 2023 to support a first group of 20 selected start-up companies to develop their businesses;	• Continue CASSINI Matchmaking with four thematic events at tech conferences and online pitch events planned in 2023. The four themes will be on Smart Logistics and Transportation, Smart Cities and Urban Mobility, Managing and Protecting Earth's Resources from Space, and Next-Gen Spacecraft Manufacturing and Operation. The management of the CASSINI matchmaking events will be delegated to EUSPA.

A study on the funding of space start-ups will be launched in 2023 to assess the progress and impact achieved by CASSINI this far and to conceptualise further measures in the areas to be identified.

For Copernicus, contract opportunities for European New Space companies (start-ups, scale-ups and SMEs) are promoted by using an **online dynamic purchasing system** (DPS). This system is allowing for open enrolment, automated procurement whilst facilitating competition and fast-track contracting. In parallel, DG DEFIS continues to work very closely with ESA to modernise the Copernicus contributing missions' commercial data-buy by updating and **innovating the procurement principles** and processes to match the data needs of Copernicus services.

Seeking to act as **anchor customer for EU launch services**, procurements through open competition will be launched in 2023 (see also section D). While maintaining a topic on high thrust propulsion for strategic launchers, the Commission intends to include new topics linked to the recovery of space transportation vehicles and in-orbit servicing while improving flexibility and openness of European test and launch facilities.

Global systems with global reach

Promoting the international uptake of the EU Space Programme and strengthening Europe's role as **a strong global space actor** implies a range of international engagements with third countries, international organisations, and concluding administrative arrangements and international agreements with key partners.

In the field of Earth observation, international cooperation strengthens the EU's capacity to monitor the implementation of global agreements such as the Paris Climate Agreement and the UN SDGs. The growing use of Copernicus data by the international scientific community **reinforces the EU's voice in international climate change talks and negotiations**. In addition to implementing the existing Copernicus cooperation arrangements, a number of new arrangements based on reciprocity and the EU's strategic interests could be concluded during 2023 ⁽¹⁰⁾.

To **support the uptake** of Galileo and EGNOS services worldwide and/or to promote **technical cooperation with key international players**, bilateral agreements and administrative arrangements ⁽¹¹⁾ have been signed **in the field of satellite navigation**. Discussions are ongoing to expand cooperation in 2023 with strategic international partners, including for the Galileo PRS, where alliances play a crucial and strategic role. Negotiations should be finalised with Norway, advanced with the U.S. and prepared with Canada and possibly other priority countries. DG DEFIS will continue negotiating agreements for the extension of EGNOS services to the Eastern and Southern neighbourhoods and explore the expansion of EGNOS system coverage to other regions.

DG DEFIS will also continue to promote the EU Space Programme's operational needs and strategic interests through different **international and multilateral fora**, such as the International Telecommunications Union (for frequencies), the International Committee on GNSS, COSPAS-SARSAT, the Working Groups under the EU-U.S. GNSS Cooperation Agreement, the Group on Earth Observations (GEO), and the Committee on Earth Observation satellites (CEOS), among others.

DG DEFIS will resume its **space dialogues with key international partners** (e.g. U.S. and Japan) and launch new ones with new partners, such as Australia and Canada, as well as with the African Union. In the frame of the new Agenda for Latin America and the Caribbean, DG DEFIS will be seeking to reinforce the role of EU space-enabled services to support businesses and SMEs in this region of growing strategic and economic importance.

DG DEFIS will continue its cooperation with the DG for International Partnerships (INTPA) to support the second phase of the "GMES ⁽¹²⁾ and Africa" initiative and continue managing the third support activity of the Joint Programming Office (JPO) of EGNOS in Africa; preparing the critical design review phase for a satellite-based augmentation system (SBAS) extension in the ASECNA region ⁽¹³⁾; and preparing the next phase for an EGNOS V3 coverage of Africa.

⁽¹⁰⁾ E.g. Canada, Japan, Argentina, Indonesia, Vietnam, Bangladesh, Panama, Thailand, Holy See, the Philippines, United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), and the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO).

⁽¹¹⁾ Administrative arrangements in preparation with some Latin American countries.

⁽¹²⁾ Global Monitoring of Environment and Security – precursor to the Copernicus programme.

⁽¹³⁾ Agence pour la sécurité de la navigation aérienne en Afrique et à Madagascar (ASECNA).

Other important initiatives

DG DEFIS is actively seeking **synergies between space and defence policies and industries**, supporting the EU's drive towards the digital transition, but also contributing to build resilience, safety and security ⁽¹⁴⁾. On top of contributing to the general objective of 'A stronger Europe in the world', **the EDF addresses the objective of making 'Europe fit for the digital age'** by accelerating the overall digital transformation of the defence sector and supporting inter alia information superiority and cyber. Projects directly relevant to the digital transformation will be starting in 2023, whilst new applications submitted will be evaluated.

To respond to the growing number of cyberattacks targeting military and civilian critical infrastructure and to improve cooperation and coordination, DG DEFIS will continue to co-lead with the EEAS and DG CNECT the development and implementation of the **Joint Communication on the EU Policy on Cyber Defence** ⁽¹⁵⁾ towards reducing strategic dependencies and to ensure a full-spectrum cyber defence capability in the EU. Cyber defence R&D and joint capability development will be supported under the EDF. In 2023 DG DEFIS will propose **a technology roadmap for critical cyber technologies** to facilitate synergies between defence and civilian cyber research and innovation. DG DEFIS will contribute to the implementation of the **Drone Strategy 2.0** focusing in particular on strengthening civil and defence drone industry capabilities.

DG DEFIS will continue leading the implementation of several actions of the **Action Plan on Synergies for Civil, Defence and Space Industries**. An example is the long-term action on the **Observatory of Critical Technologies (OCT)**, which is under development by the Commissions' Joint Research Centre (DG JRC) and DG DEFIS and is expected to become operational by 2023. Building on previous strands of work, the OCT will identify critical technologies, monitor associated risks and perform technology watch to identify emerging and potentially disruptive technologies with strong potential impacts on space and defence innovation as well as EU non-dependence. On this basis, DG DEFIS will lead the development of technology roadmaps based on which the Commission may decide to launch flagship projects taking into account their likely impact on the technological sovereignty and leadership of the EU, their sources of financing and their governance

Reinforcing industrial strategic autonomy requires limiting dependencies and building up strategic reserves where supply is at risk. As announced in the 2022 SOTEU, the Commission will push for creating a **European Sovereignty Fund** to make sure that the future of the industry is made in Europe. DG DEFIS will contribute to designing this new fund, building on existing and ongoing analysis of strategic dependencies and resilience of the EU value chains in the aerospace and defence ecosystem. DG DEFIS will also be closely

⁽¹⁴⁾ To be noted, these actions go beyond the DG DEFIS specific objectives 2.1 and 2.2, are complementary to the specific objectives 4.1 and 5.1 in this Management Plan.

⁽¹⁵⁾ JOIN(2022) 49 final.

involved in the preparation of the **European Critical Raw Materials Act** seeking to ensure the EU resilience and security objectives.

DG DEFIS is actively contributing to the **screening of Foreign Direct Investments (FDI)** ⁽¹⁶⁾, an essential tool to mitigate possible risks, for the security or public order in Member States in the Union, linked to non-EU investments in European companies.

To deliver on the EU's updated industrial strategy, **a transition pathway for the aerospace and defence ecosystem will be set out**. Seeking to achieve and speed up the digital, green and resilient transitions, stakeholders will be engaged through public consultations and workshops in 2023, to co-create the pathway.

Communication

2023 having been declared the **European Year of Skills**, particular attention will be brought to communicating with the entire ecosystem, including SMEs, via 'Skills Days' and dedicated workshops highlighting the critical importance of skills for the space and defence sectors. Activities will continue to accompany the emergence of a business and innovation-friendly model in Europe by promoting opportunities created by CASSINI beyond the space sector.

The established network of 'ambassadors' for the EU Space Programme will further boost the uptake of applications, with a focus on reinforcing synergies between the network of Copernicus Relays, the network of Copernicus Academy and the Galileo Information Centres.

In 2023, efforts will be invested in promoting the EU Space Programme in mainstream media, and in raising awareness about the potential of EU Space data for downstream businesses. A strong presence will be ensured at events gathering the space sector.

C. A stronger Europe in the world

Specific objective 4.1: Fostered innovation capacity and competitiveness of the European defence industry and strengthened EU defence supply chains due to increased cross-border R&D cooperation involving in particular SMEs and mid-caps

Common defence procurement

In the context of Russia's unprovoked and unjustified military aggression against Ukraine and to follow up on the Versailles Declaration of 2022, the Commission was tasked to help Member States to invest together, better and in a European way. Delivering on the 2022 **Joint Communication on the Defence Investment Gaps Analysis and Way Forward**

⁽¹⁶⁾ [EUR-Lex - 32019R0452 - EN - EUR-Lex \(europa.eu\)](#).

(¹⁷), the Commission proposed an urgent short-term instrument (EUR 500 million) for a **European Defence Industry Reinforcement through common Procurement Act (EDIRPA)**, expected to be adopted by the European Parliament and Council by early 2023. This initiative aims at encouraging Member States to cooperate in defence procurement, giving the European defence industry the visibility it needs to ramp up production capacities. DG DEFIS is also preparing a long-term measure for a regulation on a **European Defence Investment Programme (EDIP)** by 2023. The Joint Communication also established a **Defence Joint Procurement Task Force** to support the coordination of Member States on most urgent procurement needs by consolidating demand and identifying production capacity across the EU to deliver against these needs.

The European Defence Fund (EDF)

A competitive, resilient and innovative European defence ecosystem is key for establishing a European Defence Union. DG DEFIS' defence policies are aimed at reducing internal market barriers and fragmentation and at addressing existing and potential future harmful dependencies. These policies should build the conditions for Europe to act and cooperate with international and regional partners, including NATO wherever possible, while being able to operate autonomously when and where necessary.

To continue the roll out and implementation of the EDF, **the annual 2023 work programme** is planned to be adopted by end of March 2023. A significant number of priority topics will be addressed in this third annual cycle of implementation of the Programme, building on the achievements of the previous years.



(¹⁷) JOIN(2022) 24 final.

In steering the discussions with the Member States and Norway, DG DEFIS will strive to keep the overall balance achieved in 2021 and 2022 between research and development actions, and across the technologies and capabilities spectrum. In implementing the programme at a higher stage of maturity, DG DEFIS will also contribute to deepening the reflection on how to achieve the requisite degree of continuity in the effort deployed to achieve the list of main expected outcomes identified, in line with the EU capability priorities commonly agreed by Member States, in particular through the Strategic Compass for Security and Defence ⁽¹⁸⁾ and the Capability Development Plan (CDP).

Supporting defence related SMEs and defence innovation

The recent **EU Defence Innovation Scheme (EUDIS)** ⁽¹⁹⁾, a tailored toolbox supporting companies to transform ideas into innovative defence products and applications, will be continued in 2023. DG DEFIS will be working closely with partners such as EDA to ensure coherence and complementary with other initiatives. **The 2023 EDF calls will include two new types of calls that contribute to EUDIS:** spin-in calls to adapt civil innovations to defence requirements and calls targeted at cross-border defence innovation networks to create and provide test opportunities for innovative players and hackathon events. A dedicated CASSINI hackathon on 'Space for defence & security' will be organised in March 2023.

Addressing the skill gap in the defence sector, DG DEFIS is exploring the possibilities for implementing **targeted skill development** actions in the framework of the EDF and under the umbrella of EUDIS. Selected SME beneficiaries under the EDF 2021 open SME calls and the open calls for disruptive technologies for defence will start receiving **business coaching** in 2023. A 'Defence Equity Facility' under the InvestEU programme will take effect in 2023 to facilitate access to **equity for SMEs and midcaps** that are developing innovative defence technologies.

Other important initiatives

As announced in the 2022 SOTEU's letter of intent, the Commission will be stepping up its work on defence and focusing on strengthening the EU's resilience and security. Building on the Strategic Compass, DG DEFIS is working closely with the EEAS on an  **EU Space Strategy for Security and Defence** to be adopted in the first quarter of 2023. The strategy will recognise space as a new strategic domain for security and defence and propose several actions to improve the protection of the space systems and space-based services in the Union, including the resilience of the aerospace ecosystem. The strategy will also propose actions to develop space capabilities in support of security and defence, to respond to attacks targeting space infrastructure and to cooperate at international level for responsible behaviour in outer space.

⁽¹⁸⁾ Approved by the Council on 21 March 2022:

<https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-7371-2022-INIT/en/pdf>

⁽¹⁹⁾ https://ec.europa.eu/info/publications/contributing-european-defence_en

Linked to this initiative and to follow up on the **Joint Communication on an EU approach for Space Traffic Management** (STM) ⁽²⁰⁾, in 2023 DG DEFIS **in line with Better Regulation** will start **preparatory work for a legislative proposal** on space law to increase the safety, security and sustainability of the space systems, services and operations.

The Joint Communication on the Defence Investment Gaps Analysis and Way Forward ⁽²¹⁾ highlighted the need for improved Military Mobility in several areas. DG DEFIS, working closely with EEAS, EDA, other Commission services (particularly the DG for Mobility and Transport (MOVE)) and EU Member States, will coordinate the implementation of the **Action Plan on Military Mobility 2.0** ⁽²²⁾, which includes measures to enhance resilience of transport infrastructure from cyber attacks and other hybrid threats, as well as to address other gaps and deficits regarding resilience.

International cooperation is recognised as an important dimension of the EU Space Programme (see also section B). **Space economic diplomacy** in particular is supporting the space industry in exploring business development opportunities in third countries. Specific activities are currently being implemented in close cooperation with the EEAS and EU Delegations through a ‘Global Action on Space’ (2021-23) financed by the Foreign Partnership Instrument (FPI).

The 2021 EU Space Regulation calls on the Commission to explore the possibility for the European Union to **declare acceptance of the relevant UN Space Treaties and Conventions**. The 2022 Joint Communication on an EU approach for STM also states that the Commission should analyse and work on possible measures needed in order to implement the obligations enshrined in those conventions. DG DEFIS is currently assessing the possibility of declaring acceptance by the EU of the rights and obligations of the UN Rescue Agreement ⁽²³⁾, the UN Liability Convention ⁽²⁴⁾ and the UN Registration Convention ⁽²⁵⁾ and will launch a study in 2023 to analyse the consequences and the options at the Union’s disposal to fulfil the commitments under such Treaties.

Communication

To raise awareness and increase the visibility of the EDF, a strong presence at important defence-related fairs will be ensured. Supported projects will be showcased to inform about funding opportunities. Non-traditional defence actors and SMEs will be a key target audience, in particular to support the implementation of skills-related actions.

⁽²⁰⁾ JOIN(2022) 4 final.

⁽²¹⁾ JOIN(2022) 24 final.

⁽²²⁾ JOIN(2022) 4 final.

⁽²³⁾ Agreement on the Rescue of Astronauts, the Return of Astronauts and the Return of Object Launched into Outer Space.

⁽²⁴⁾ Convention on International Liability for Damage Caused by Space Objects.

⁽²⁵⁾ Convention on Registration of Objects Launched into Outer Space.

DG DEFIS is stepping up its support to the **Network of European Defence Fund National Focal Points (NFPs)** through the launch of a coordination action for cross-border and jointly organised outreach activities. European thematic conferences will be organised in 2023 within the **European Network of Defence-related Regions (ENDR)**, coupled with matchmaking possibilities. The ENDR continues to be an important platform to spread the word about possible synergies between EDF and other relevant funding programmes such as the European Regional Development Fund.

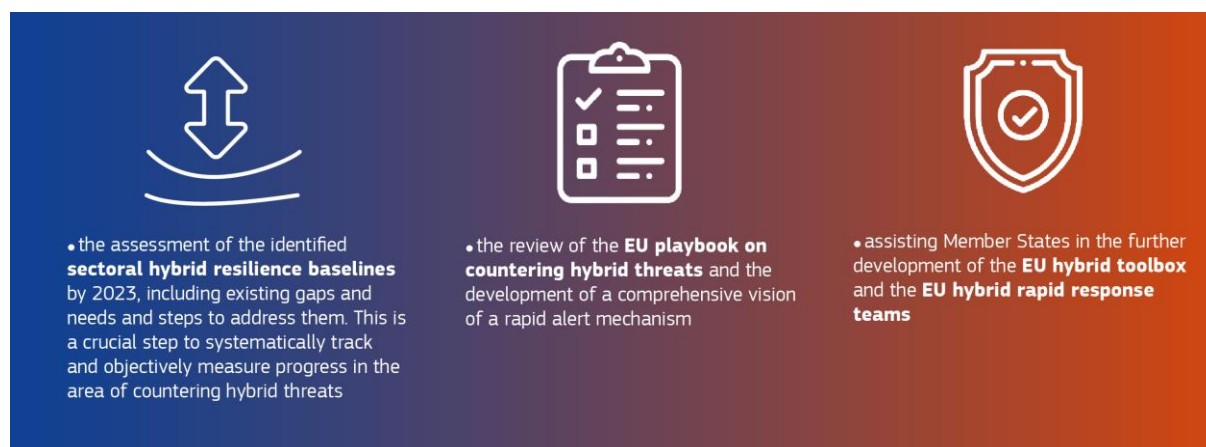
Countering disinformation is crucial in the area of defence given the sensitivity linked to this topic. DG DEFIS will pay special attention to social media communication to make sure that accurate information is relayed, along with continuous monitoring activities.

D. Promoting our European way of life

Specific objective 5.1: Security actors have access to EU autonomous tools, space-enabled services, and technologies needed to build resilience to security threats, safety hazards and crisis situations

Hybrid threats

DG DEFIS, in close co-operation with the EEAS, is responsible for the overall coordination of Commission activities with regard to the EU's ability to increase resilience and countering hybrid threats. This work will focus on:



		
• the assessment of the identified sectoral hybrid resilience baselines by 2023, including existing gaps and needs and steps to address them. This is a crucial step to systematically track and objectively measure progress in the area of countering hybrid threats	• the review of the EU playbook on countering hybrid threats and the development of a comprehensive vision of a rapid alert mechanism	• assisting Member States in the further development of the EU hybrid toolbox and the EU hybrid rapid response teams

DG DEFIS will continue to represent the Commission in the dedicated Council Working Group ⁽²⁶⁾ and provide support to the EU and its Member States to increase awareness levels, build resilience and respond in a coordinated and solidary way.

⁽²⁶⁾ Horizontal working party on enhancing resilience and countering hybrid threats.

Secure communications and cybersecurity

The GOVSATCOM component of the EU Space Programme for secure governmental communication is the first building block of IRIS² (see section B). GOVSATCOM services are expected to be provided in 2024, once the necessary infrastructure of GOVSATCOM has been deployed. The procurement of the **EU GOVSATCOM hub infrastructure** was launched in 2021, including two studies for the design of the EU GOVSATCOM hub infrastructure and the development, deployment and acceptance of the resulting infrastructure. A contract is expected to be awarded in the first quarter of 2023. In 2022, the Commission already started preparing implementing acts for the **definition of the characteristics of the GOVSATCOM service portfolio**, operational requirements, and on the sharing and prioritisation of governmental services, which are also expected to be adopted in the first quarter of 2023.

Safety and security (dual use) related space services

With the operational **EU Space Surveillance and Tracking (SST)** capacity and, in the near future, a reinforced **SSA** ⁽²⁷⁾ component under the new EU Space Programme, the Union will be increasingly autonomous in monitoring and protecting its space assets. This is a major and tangible contribution to the strategic autonomy and resilience of the Union.

In 2022, the Commission adopted a Joint Communication on an EU approach for STM ⁽²⁸⁾ which proposes several concrete actions M. In 2023, DG DEFIS will continue delivering on these actions by assessing the STM civil and defence requirements for the EU, enhancing EU operational capabilities to support STM in terms of services and technologies, assessing the STM regulatory aspects and promoting the EU STM approach globally. In 2023, DG DEFIS intends to launch a study to analyse various policy options for ensuring minimum level collision avoidance for Union's satellite operators and their potential economic, social and environmental impacts.

The duration of the current EU SST consortium providing SST services was extended for an additional six months until 1 July 2023 to allow for a smooth transition to the newly formed EU SST Partnership, which has been selected by the Commission ⁽²⁹⁾. The **EU SST Partnership** comprises 15 EU Member States and will be in charge of the provision of EU SST services for at least three years. The **EU SST front desk** will be transferred from the European Union Satellite Centre (SatCen) to the Galileo Security Monitoring Centre operated

⁽²⁷⁾ The SSA component will cover EU SST, Space Weather and Near Earth Objects (NEO), as well as an overall strengthening of security requirements when developing EU space systems.

⁽²⁸⁾ JOIN(2022) 4 final..

⁽²⁹⁾ C(2022)6942, COMMISSION DECISION on the joint proposal of EU Member States to participate in the Space Surveillance and Tracking Partnership of 5.10.2022.

by EUSPA ⁽³⁰⁾. In terms of security, DG DEFIS started preparing the SST general security requirements for a Commission implementing act to be adopted by 2023.

As part of the Galileo second generation service portfolio, a stand-alone **timing service** is under development. In parallel, the standard for future Galileo timing receivers is being developed under the frame of the European Committee for Standardization (CEN) and the European Committee for Electrotechnical Standardization (CENELEC), with a first version expected to be ready in 2023.

When it comes to **personal safety**, the **Galileo's Search and Rescue Service** (SAR) reduces drastically the time to detect emergency distress beacons from up to three hours to just ten minutes. In 2023, the 4th Medium Earth Orbit Local User Terminal (MEOLUT) ground station deployed in Reunion Island (FR), will enter into service, ensuring the expansion of detection and localisation of alerts capabilities to cover a wide area in the Indian Ocean.

The **emergency warning service** for broadcasting alerts to population at threat (natural or man-made hazards) is a direct contribution to the United Nation's Programme for Disaster Risk Resilience. In 2023, the activities will focus on finalising the service architecture and the provision scheme, leading to a procurement phase for introducing the service in the first generation of Galileo satellites. The start of the initial service is foreseen by the end of 2024. A public demonstration phase will take place during 2023, with several in-field demonstrations organised in several locations across the EU.

The **Copernicus emergency management service**, delegated to the JRC, will continue supporting actions of the EU at local, national and international level in case of major natural disasters. In addition, the three **Copernicus security services** (border surveillance, maritime surveillance, support to EU external action), delegated respectively to the European Border and Coast Guard Agency (Frontex), the European Maritime Safety Agency (EMSA) and SatCen, will rely on revamped portfolios to better respond to user needs and for improved inter-agencies cooperation.

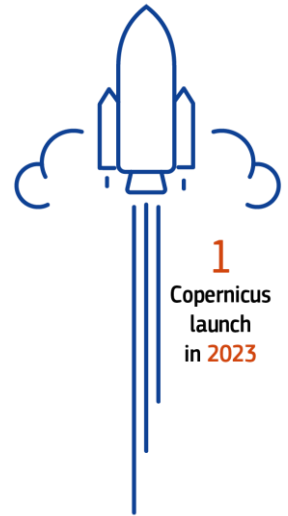
DG DEFIS will be contributing to the update of the EU Maritime Security Strategy, which is led jointly by the DG for Maritime Affairs and Fisheries (MARE) and EEAS and will ensure that the full potential of the EU Space Programme and of the EDF are fully explored and benefit security and defence users.

⁽³⁰⁾ C(2022) 3619 COMMISSION DECISION of 3.6.2022 selecting the European Union Agency for the Space Programme as the SST Front Desk pursuant to Regulation (EU) 2021/696.

Access to space and satellite launches in 2023

To stay at the forefront in the space domain, the EU needs to ensure its autonomous, reliable and cost-effective access to space with EU launch solutions, including back-ups, covering all ranges of launchers (heavy, medium and micro-launcher) and relying on fully resilient EU supply chains. This is an imperative for the autonomous deployment of Galileo, Copernicus or future flagships like IRIS².

The Commission, acting as an anchor customer for launch services of its space flagships and following a procurement, has put in place a **framework contract with Arianespace** to place long-term orders of launch services. This is a win-win for the EU industry and the EU itself by offering predictability, visibility and reinforcing the EU's role on the global scene. DG DEFIS will continue consultations on the future of the launcher sector in the EU, with all main parties and stakeholders of the entire European launch system value chain, in order to ensure autonomous EU launch solutions.



Communication

Communication actions will be developed to accompany the launch of SST/SSA/GOVSATCOM-related activities. The focus will be on raising awareness on the potential of GOVSATCOM services. This will contribute to a timely service uptake when the system will be ready to deliver the initial services.

To reach a wider audience, DG DEFIS will stage a mind-catching, real-time demonstration event of EU's achievements in space-based lifesaving services. The event will also serve to test the design of the Galileo SAR user-interface (beacon), collecting valuable feedback from demo-volunteers for further improvements. The strong promotion of services addressing other emergency situations, such as non-sensitive activations of the Copernicus emergency management service in partnership with the DG for European Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid Operations (ECHO) and the Joint Research Centre (JRC), is also planned.

DEFIS will also seize the opportunity of the Copernicus satellite launch (Sentinel-1C) to promote the benefits of EU Space to the general public.

PART 2. Modernising the administration: main outputs for 2023

The internal control framework ⁽³¹⁾ supports sound management and decision-making. It notably ensures that risks to the achievement of objectives are taken into account and are reduced to acceptable levels through cost-effective controls. DG DEFIS has established an internal control system tailored to its particular characteristics and circumstances. The effective functioning of the service's internal control system will be assessed on an ongoing basis throughout the year and be subject to a specific annual assessment covering all internal control principles.

A. Human resource management



DG DEFIS is supporting innovation and technological developments in the high-tech sectors of space and defence industry. Ensuring that the necessary expertise is available within the DG is a key aspect of human resource (HR) management. Expertise is provided through a large presence of seconded national experts (17% of staff), equally important presence of temporary agents (16% of staff) and in-house knowledge of technically-trained staff. This expertise will be reinforced by the selection of officials through specialised EPSO competitions (published in July 2022 with an expected outcome by the end of 2023) to attract highly skilled candidates with experience in the field of space and defence.

DG DEFIS has established a **tailored local HR strategy** based on the list of workforce planning and learning needs of the DG DEFIS. An Away Day will be organised again in 2023 to allow DG DEFIS staff to better know each other, improve staff awareness of the DG's objectives and enhance the inter-unit collaboration. The first Away Day organised in 2022 after the COVID-19 pandemic was extremely useful in terms of working methods, including suggestions on how to break silos.

Internal communication activities will be continued to keep staff well informed about the latest developments i.e. via the weekly internal newsletters 'DEFIS BUZZ', the organisation of DG DEFIS' lab seminars and regular staff meeting(s) with the Director-General. Two dedicated seminars for newcomers will be organised in physical form in 2023 to allow staff to reconnect after the long teleworking periods of 2020 – 2021. In this respect, DG DEFIS remains in the particular situation that shortly after its creation (1 January 2020) the work pattern changed to teleworking mode predominantly and that natural links between colleagues need thus to be reinforced.

More generally, DG DEFIS wants to retain its talents and focuses on **enabling people** to unlock their full potential by matching people's competencies and aspirations with corporate business needs. The HR Correspondent team will therefore focus on allocating

⁽³¹⁾ [Communication C\(2017\)2373 - Revision of the Internal Control Framework](#).

human resources taking due account of the Commission's work programme and DG DEFIS' policy priorities. Quotas for staff and budget for external staff will be managed by the HR correspondent in close cooperation with senior management to allow for flexibility and reactivity to changing needs in light of the implementation of the EU Space Programme and EDF, EDIRPA and the Union Secure Connectivity Programme (IRIS²).

DG DEFIS will promote internal mobility, mentoring and flexible staff allocation that will be put in practice fully in 2023. These actions will give insights to staff into the work of other units and facilitate synergies, including between the Space Programme, the EDF and Horizon Europe.

DG DEFIS is also encouraging the set-up of **thematic taskforces to facilitate cross-directorate cooperation** and to leverage existing expertise in the DG. Four taskforces will be continued in 2023, focusing on (i) skills (in view of the European Year for Skills in 2023); (ii) raw materials (to inform the reflection on the Critical Raw Materials Act); (iii) IRIS² (to prepare the market consultation and subsequent call for tender) and (iv) the development of Copernicus Earth observation services for governmental use.

In relation to gender balance, when selecting middle managers, the DG will be attentive to respecting the gender balance reached for middle management functions (50% at present for the 12 occupied posts). The HRBC team will map and encourage eligible staff to apply to the corporate Female Talent Development Programme 2023.

The implementation of DG DEFIS' workplan on Equality, Diversity and Inclusion, which includes a series of actions going beyond gender equality, will be continued. The **improvement of working conditions** is continuously pursued. The focus will be on raising awareness among staff and on making full use of work/life balance instruments available for staff.

Learning and development opportunities will be promoted by means of internal communication channels. Introductory training and mentoring for newcomers will be organised on regular basis. DG DEFIS will advertise presential and e-learning opportunities for colleagues (i.e. webinars, e-learning modules, lunch-time labs) and talent management projects.

The relevant performance table can be found in the Annex (page 35).

B. Sound financial management



In line with its control strategy, DG DEFIS will ensure that the objectives set in the relevant performance table are met (see Annex, page 36). Moreover, the tight supervision, through both budgetary and cost control of entrusted entities,

supporting the implementation of DG DEFIS programmes, will continue. In 2023, DG DEFIS will be attentive to ensuring a smooth implementation of the EDF and EDIRPA ⁽³²⁾. The necessary financial controls will be carried out during the grant preparation stage to provide assurance to the authorising officer for grant signature.

DG DEFIS will support and contribute to developing a corporate common approach in financial management, through eProcurement, the Public Procurement Management Tool (PPMT), eGrant for the EDF grants and the management of expert groups (AGM, RegExp...). All the above actions and controls will ensure that DG DEFIS can manage adequately the risks related to the legality and regularity of the underlying transactions, taking into account the multiannual character of the programmes, as well as the nature of the payments concerned. The main control objective is to ensure that the estimated risk at closure is below 2% of the relevant expenditure (materiality threshold).

C. Fraud risk management



DG DEFIS developed an anti-fraud strategy with a set of actions that will continue in 2023. The strategy will be reviewed in the light of an increased volume of actions under direct management with the implementation of the EDF. DG DEFIS will emphasise ethics and fraud prevention through proportionate and targeted preventive ex-ante controls.

DG DEFIS explains staff obligations, ethics and fraud prevention to new staff members during a mandatory newcomers' training session. Moreover, ex-ante controls are performed both during the pre-contractual and the contractual phases to prevent fraud i.e. with a certificate on the absence of flag from the Commission's Early Warning System and the Central Exclusion Database (EDES) or notably through desk check control for grants.

Particular attention is put on fraud risk management of the EDF. The evaluations of grant proposals are done in cooperation with independent external experts to avoid conflict of interests and lobbying by stakeholders. Ex-ante controls are performed during the pre-contractual phase of the EDF grant agreement signatures: a full financial viability is performed for most partners, notably to assess the level of pre-financing that may be granted after the signature of the agreement. In addition, control assessments are processed to ensure that the involved companies are EU-owned, are SMEs or not, and to determine accordingly the right level of EU support. Moreover, the defence sector is strongly supervised by Member States which in itself decreases the risk of systemic fraud in companies.

The relevant performance table can be found in the Annex (page 37).

⁽³²⁾ Pending adoption of the EDIRPA legal basis expected in early 2023.

D. Digital transformation and information management



DG DEFIS becomes fully independent in the area of IT information and data protection management as from 1 January 2023, discontinuing shared responsibilities under a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between DG DEFIS and the DG for Internal Market, Industry, Entrepreneurship and SMEs (GROW) since the creation of DG DEFIS in 2020.

Fostering a digital culture

An Information Resource Manager (IRM) and a technical assistant were appointed in September 2022 to take over IT tasks that were previously carried out by DG GROW. The IRM is also handling the portfolio manager role, acquiring competences by participating to portfolio manager community and Digital Stakeholders Forum (DSF) events. In 2023, DG DEFIS will roll out actions to strengthen literacy skills and awareness, for example, with sessions on the handling of classified information (EUCI) and cybersecurity awareness campaigns led by DG for Informatics (DIGIT), and with innovative solutions to improve collaboration, data for policy usage and stakeholder engagement.

DG DEFIS contributes to the corporate data governance and data policies as a member of internal market team of the Information and Management Steering Board (IMSB).

Digital policymaking

Supporting policy systems, like the 'European Defence Industry Platform' and the 'Online platform for recruiting and interaction between coaches and SMEs', will be developed considering interoperability and re-using corporate digital components. The IRM will contribute to the conception of these systems to support the policy teams to identify potential re-usable components that can fit the objectives of these two IT systems. Additionally, DG DEFIS will observe and detect digital possibilities to improve or develop IT systems, IT services, etc. based on re-usable components.

Business-driven digital transformation

DG DEFIS is not planning to use or experiment with innovative technologies. However, it will observe the usage of innovative technologies within the Commission IT systems to benefit from them, if applicable.

Digital landscape

Considering the limited IT staff resources and in line with the "re-use, before buy, before build" principle described in the "dual-pillar approach to meet the Commission's demand for digital solutions" paper ⁽³³⁾, DG DEFIS will limit to the maximum extent the development of new applications. DG DEFIS, as the owner of a limited number of communication and information systems, will reinforce the monitoring of IT investments and continue the

⁽³³⁾ [Dual-Pillar-Approach-Post-ITCB.pdf \(europa.eu\)](#)

ongoing process to update/develop IT security plans for all the systems owned by DG DEFIS and compliance with the IT security standards.

Green, secure and resilient infrastructure

In coordination with DG DIGIT and following the corporate schedule, DG DEFIS will continue the migration of its staff to the WELCOME environment, the new digital environment of the Commission to gradually replace the current environment, NET1. WELCOME will enable a digital workplace that is optimised for remote and hybrid work, more resilient to cyberattacks and overall much better adapted to the new ways of working in our organisation.

Information and IT security rules

DG DEFIS contributes to the corporate data governance and data policies as a member of the internal market team of the Information and Management Steering Board (IMSB). In 2023, the priority will be to review the state of play of DG DEFIS IT applications with a specific focus on IT security.

Data protection

To ensure rigorous implementation of the data protection rules, DG DEFIS Data Protection Coordinator (DPC) will focus efforts on three areas:

- increase awareness at all levels of DG DEFIS staff, focusing on the needs of every type of actor and on the practical implementation, e.g. the most recurrent and risky activities, such as public procurement, meetings and events, consultations, IT tools, international transfers and on data subject procedures;
- promote the use of 'unit inventories' of processing operations to improve continuous compliance monitoring and in particular the implementation of the Commission's Data Protection Action Plan (C(2018) 7432 final);
- ensure that DG DEFIS IT systems and websites comply with data protection rules, including security aspects.

DG DEFIS will continue working on mapping the degree of implementation per unit (to target awareness actions) and inform internally about the latest corporate developments. It will further focus on ensuring compliance with data protection rules and the prevention and handling of data protection breaches.

The relevant performance table can be found in the Annex (page 37).

E. Sound environmental management



In 2023, DG DEFIS intends to contribute to the implementation of the action plan and Commission Communication on greening the Commission ⁽³⁴⁾, with the objective to reduce net greenhouse gas emissions by at least 60% by 2030 compared to 2005 and to compensate carbon emissions with carbon removals in order to reach climate neutrality by 2030 by focusing on the following actions:

- systematic verification of missions by management to ensure that they are necessary and cannot be performed online;
- favouring hybrid format meetings and events to facilitate remote participation without the need for travelling;
- digitalisation of the workplace by promoting paperless working processes;
- participation to circular economy initiatives i.e. through dedicated calls aiming to greening the aerospace and defence industry.

To maximise the impact of space data, services and applications in support of the EU's Green Deal, the use of environmentally-oriented actions supported by the EU Space Programme and Horizon Europe will continue to be encouraged. In addition, as part of the EDF, research and development actions for green technologies in the defence and aerospace sectors will be implemented.

The implementation of the Commission guidelines for sustainable meetings and events ⁽³⁵⁾ and of the specific guidelines circulated in 2020 will continue to be promoted via internal communication channels. Corporate campaigns will be handled in close partnership with OIB and DG GROW, with which DG DEFIS shares its building.

The relevant performance table can be found in the Annex (page 38).

F. Initiatives to improve economy and efficiency of financial and non-financial activities

In order to reduce the environmental impact and following the efforts made in previous years, digital solutions are strongly encouraged in DG DEFIS whenever possible and appropriate. In close cooperation with DIGIT, investments in modern and secured equipment allowing to hold professional videoconferencing instead of traveling worldwide intensively for negotiations. Some concrete examples of actions: (i) reduction of the number of missions together with a limited number of staff per mission; (ii) considerable reduction of mission budgets and of carbon footprint of the DG; (iii) substitution of traditional promotional materials with sustainable promotional materials.

⁽³⁴⁾ C(2022) 2230

⁽³⁵⁾ https://ec.europa.eu/environment/emas/pdf/other/EC_Guide_Sustainable_Meetings_and_Events.pdf

Moreover, DG DEFIS is constantly revising its working processes and will improve them when possible.

G. Security and Information



Under the framework of the EDF Regulation, the EU Space Regulation and the FDI Screening Regulation, DG DEFIS handles sensitive and classified information (EUCI). DG DEFIS is a prime target for those actors that seek to gather sensitive information because it manages a significant volume of sensitive and classified information and due to the strategic dimension of the policies and programmes covered by its mission. DG DEFIS information security strategy from 2020 identified five objectives:

1. active contributor to the reinforcement of the Commission security;
2. internal security organisation of DG DEFIS;
3. security awareness of DG DEFIS staff;
4. secure DG DEFIS sensitive non-classified or classified RESTREINT UE/EU RESTRICTED;
5. secure DG DEFIS information that is classified CONFIDENTIEL UE/EU CONFIDENTIAL and SECRET UE/EU SECRET.

In 2022, DG DEFIS tested new RUE laptops (RTOP) developed by HR.DS. Moreover, SUE stations were deployed in a DG DEFIS secure room to enable the digitalisation of the handling of CUE and SUE documents. When SUE system will be accredited, the security operational procedures (SECOPS) of DG DEFIS secure room will be updated in order to fully benefiting of the new SUE functionalities.

Awareness and training is crucial for the building of a security mind-set. Based on lessons learnt, DG DEFIS staff will be encouraged to update their knowledge on the handling of EUCI and on cyber-security via online trainings developed by HR.DS. In addition, DG DEFIS management will receive quarterly reports on the security status of the DG with a view to raising security awareness and to strengthening DG DEFIS security culture.

All staff of DG DEFIS will have to be in possession of a valid security clearance or have started the process to obtain it.

The relevant performance table can be found in the Annex (page 40).

Annex 1 – DG DEFIS performance tables

General objective: A European Green Deal

Specific objective: 1.1 Reliable data and services of the EU Space Programme are cornerstones for the monitoring of, and transition to, climate-neutrality and ecological sustainability

Related to spending programme(s): EU Space Programme

Main outputs in 2023:

External communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Touring exhibition Space for Our Planet	- Number of events organised - Number of participants	- 10 different locations in different countries - 50.000 participants
Touring of “Copernicus Earth Art” exhibition	- Number of events organised - Number of participants	- 6 locations in different EU Member States (geographically balanced) - 10.000 participants
Promotion of EU Space based opportunities for agriculture: - Berlin International Green Week, Berlin (DE) - International Agriculture Show, Paris (FR)	- Number of events organised - Number of participants	- Stands and training sessions at 2 agriculture related events in the EU - 30.000 participants
Organisation of a high-level conference on the benefits of Copernicus for the Planet amid its 25 th Anniversary, Stockholm (SE)	- Number of participants	- 1.500 participants (500 onsite + 1.000 online)
Animation of a webpage dedicated to DG DEFIS policies contribution to the Green Deal objective	- Number of visits	- 5.000 visits

Other important outputs

Output	Indicator	Target
Copernicus European State of the Climate Report	Publication of the report	Q2 2023
Annual Ocean State Report	Publication in the “Science” Journal State of the Planet special issue	Q4 2023
Pilot project study for high-cadence monitoring for the EU Green Deal relating to EU Space Programme (Copernicus)	Launch of study contract	Q1 2023
Contribute to the Commission’s Communication on climate and defence	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023

General objective: A Europe fit for the digital age

Specific objective: 2.1: Modern and well-functioning EU space-enabled services to support the Union's priorities

Related to spending programme(s): EU Space Programme,

Main outputs in 2023:

Initiatives linked to regulatory simplification and burden reduction

Output	Indicator	Target
Implementing act on IRIS ² portfolio of governmental services, operational requirements for governmental services and detailed rules on the provision of governmental services	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023
Commission implementing decision on adoption of 2023 work programme of the Union Secure Connectivity Programme	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023
Commission implementing decision on entrusting budget implementation tasks to the European Union Agency for the Space Programme and the European Space Agency linked to provision of satellite governmental communication services	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023

Evaluations and fitness checks

Output	Indicator	Target
EU Space Programme cost-benefit analysis study in preparation of a mid-term evaluation	Launch of the study	Q1 2023 (January)

External communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Organisation of a launch event for the secure connectivity initiative IRIS ²	- Number of participants	- 1.000 participants (300 onsite + 700 online)

Other important outputs

Output	Indicator	Target
Regulation establishing the Union Secure Connectivity Programme	Adoption by the co-legislators	Q1 2023
EU Space Programme study on synergies between the European Defence Fund (EDF) and the EU space policy	Launch of the study	Q1 2023

Output	Indicator	Target
EU Space Programme feasibility study (or studies) to support the implementation of the EU Space Strategy for Security and Defence	Launch of the study(ies)	Q3 2023

General objective: A Europe fit for the digital age

Specific objective: 2.2: EU Space Programme maximises socio-economic benefits

Related to spending programme(s): EU Space Programme, European Defence Fund, Horizon Europe

Main outputs in 2023:

New policy initiatives

Output	Indicator	Target
Comprehensive strategy for supporting the uptake of EU space services	Publication of the strategy - standalone staff working document	Q4 2023

Public consultations

Output	Indicator	Target
Transition pathway for the aerospace and defence ecosystem	Launch public consultation	Q1 2023

External communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Promotion of EU Space , EDF and AZEA opportunities for entrepreneurship and skills development within the ecosystem: - 15th European Space Conference, Brussels (BE) - Paris Air Show, Paris (FR)	- Number of events - Number of participants	- 2 events - 75.000 participants
Promotion of EU Space based opportunities for entrepreneurship and skills development beyond the ecosystem: - Web Summit (PT) - Winter Wonders, Brussels (BE)	- Number of events - Number of participants	- 2 events - 200.000 participants
Organisation of workshops on DG DEFIS-led initiatives to support the Union of Equality	- Number of workshops - Number of participants	- 4 workshops - 500 participants
Animation of a webpage dedicated to DG DEFIS-led policies contribution to the digital age	- Number of visits	- 5.000 visits

Other important outputs		
Output	Indicator	Target
EU space partnership (Horizon Europe)	Launch initiative	Q2 2023
CASSINI Business Accelerator	Launch initiative	Q1 2023
Launch study on space start-ups funding	Launch study	Q1 2023
Transition pathway for the aerospace and defence ecosystem	Publication of the transition pathway	Q3 2023

General objective: A Stronger Europe in the World

Specific objective: 4.1: Fostered innovation capacity and competitiveness of the European defence industry and strengthened EU defence supply chains due to increased cross-border R&D cooperation involving in particular SMEs and mid-caps

Related to spending programme(s): EU Space Programme, European Defence Fund

Main outputs in 2023:

New policy initiatives

Output	Indicator	Target
Proposal for a regulation of a European Defence Investment Programme (EDIP)	Adoption by the Commission	Q2 2023
 EU space strategy for security and defence	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023

External communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Increase awareness of the achievements of EDF	- Number of engagement on social media	- 300.000 engagements on social media channels
Organisation of EDF Info Days, Brussels (BE)	- Number of participants	- 2.000 participants
Participation in national EDF Info Days with expert speakers with a geographical balance	- Number of workshops - Number of participants	- 5 events - 500 participants
Promotion of EU's defence industry initiatives at fairs	- Number of participants	- 10.000 attendees

Other important outputs

Output	Indicator	Target
European Defence Industry Reinforcement through common Procurement Act (EDIRPA)	Adoption by the co-legislators	Q1 2023

Output	Indicator	Target
2023-2024 European Defence Industry Reinforcement through common Procurement Act (EDIRPA) multiannual work programme	Adoption by Commission pending the adoption of the legislative proposal by co-legislators	Q4 2023
2023 EDF work programme	Adoption by Commission	Q1 2023
Adoption of the award decision for the EDF 2022 Calls	Adoption by Commission	Q4 2023
Launching a study to analyse the consequences for the Union and the options at the Union's disposal to fulfil the commitments under the UN Rescue Agreement, the UN Liability Convention and the UN Registration Convention, should the EU declare its acceptance.	Launch of the study	Q1 2023

General objective: Promoting our European way of life

Specific objective: 5.1: Security actors have access to EU autonomous tools, space-enabled services, and technologies, needed to build resilience to security threats, safety hazards and crisis situations

Related to spending programme(s): EU Space Programme, European Defence Fund

Main outputs in 2023:

New policy initiatives

Output	Indicator	Target
Commission implementing acts for the definition of the characteristics of the GOVSATCOM service portfolio, operational requirements, and on the sharing and prioritisation governmental services.	Adoption by the Commission	Q1 2023
Commission implementing act on SST general security requirements	Adoption by the Commission	Q4 2023

External communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Promotion of DG DEFIS Policies at EU Open Doors Day	- Number of participants	- 5.000 participants
Partnership with Brussels city to promote EU Space-based opportunities at Winter Wonders through interactive exhibition and info sessions	- Number of participants	- 500.000 participants

Output	Indicator	Target
Promotion of EU Space / Galileo SAR/ Copernicus Emergency Management Service activation	- Number of engagement/impressions on social media - Number of participants (physical and online) - Number of engagement/impressions on social media - Number of events - Number of journalists/influencers following the event	- 3.000.000 engagements/impressions on social media channels - 5.000 participants - 1.000.000 engagements/impressions on social media channels - 1 live demonstration organised - 20 journalists/influencers
Animation of a dedicated webpage on DG DEFIS Europa platform promoting DG DEFIS contribution to this objective	- Number of visits	- 5.000 visits

Other important outputs

Output	Indicator	Target
Launching a study to analyse various policy options for ensuring minimum level collision avoidance for Union's satellite operators and their potential economic, social and environmental impacts.	Launch of the study	Q1 2023

Objective: *DG DEFIS employs a competent and engaged workforce and contributes to gender equality at all levels of management to effectively deliver on the Commission's priorities and core business.*

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
Reaching quantitative DG targets for female appointments to middle management functions.	- Female appointment to middle management positions	- 50 % of middle management positions
Promote virtual and e-learning opportunities for colleagues (i.e. webinars, e-learning modules)	- Number of virtual and e-learning trainings followed by DG DEFIS staff	- 10 % of trainings followed by virtual means

Output	Indicator	Target
Reaching quantitative DG targets for female appointments to middle management functions.	- Female appointment to middle management positions	- 50 % of middle management positions
Organise an away day	- Staff attendance - Staff satisfaction survey	- 90 % of DG DEFIS staff
Staff's emotional, cognitive and physical connection to the job, organisation and the people within it	- Staff Engagement Index ³⁶	- 62,5% in 2021

Internal communication actions

Output	Indicator	Target
Maintenance and animation of DG DEFIS intracomm website	- Number of visits	- 5.000 visits
Publication of weekly internal newsletters 'DEFIS BUZZ'	- Number of recipients and readers	- 150 readers per edition
Organisation of DG DEFIS Lab seminars	- Number of editions - Number of participants	- 6 editions - 400 participants
Organisation of regular meeting(s) of the Director-General with the staff	- Number of meetings - Number of participants and quality of interactions	- 4 meetings - 175 participants each
Promotion of EMAS and organisation of EMAS events to promote corporate campaigns	- Number of events	- At least 1

Objective: *The authorising officer by delegation has reasonable assurance that resources have been used in accordance with the principles of sound financial management and that cost-effective controls are in place which give the necessary guarantees concerning the legality and regularity of underlying transactions.*

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
Effective controls: Legal and regular transactions	Risk at payment	Remains < 2 % of relevant expenditure ⁽³⁷⁾
	Estimated risk at closure	Remains < 2 % of relevant expenditure

⁽³⁶⁾ DG DEFIS was created end of 2019 by the transfer from DG GROW of Directorates I and J. The staff engagement index for these two directorates was 60% in 2018 and was taken as baseline for DG DEFIS.

⁽³⁷⁾ For the Research, industry, space, energy and transport family, it is necessary to make a distinction between Horizon 2020 and Horizon Europe since they have different materiality criteria for the risk at payment (see also management plan 2022).

Output	Indicator	Target
Effective controls: Safeguarded assets (<i>where relevant</i>) Safeguarded information (<i>where relevant</i>)	Percentage of write-off of the value of the assets due to inventory mismanagement	< 1% of the total value of the assets
Efficient controls	- Budget execution - Timely payments	- Remains <1% of commitment and payment appropriations is not executed - Remains >98% of payments (in value) made on time
Economy of controls	- Overall cost of control as a percentage of the total commitment appropriations consumed at the end of the year. - Overall cost of control as a percentage of the total annual amount delegated excluding any remuneration paid	- Remains less than 10% of funds managed - Remains less than 5% of funds managed

Objective: *The risk of fraud is minimised through the application of effective anti-fraud measures and the implementation of the Commission Anti-Fraud Strategy (CAFS) ⁽³⁸⁾ aimed at the prevention, detection and correction ⁽³⁹⁾ of fraud.*

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
Assessing the risks of fraud for grants financed under direct management	Update the anti-fraud strategy	Document ready by mid-2023

Objective: *DG DEFIS is using innovative, trusted digital solutions for better policy-shaping, information management and administrative processes to forge a truly digitally transformed, user-focused and data-driven Commission*

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
--------	-----------	--------

⁽³⁸⁾ Communication from the Commission 'Commission Anti-Fraud Strategy: enhanced action to protect the EU budget', COM(2019) 196 of 29 April 2019 – 'the CAFS Communication' – and the accompanying action plan, SWD(2019) 170 – 'the CAFS Action Plan'.

⁽³⁹⁾ Correction of fraud is an umbrella term, which notably refers to the recovery of amounts unduly spent and to administrative sanctions.

Increase staff cyber-awareness in DG DEFIS	- Percentage of staff attending awareness raising activities.	- Staff: 50%
Update/develop IT security plans	- Percentage of IT systems with an IT security plan	- 40% of IT systems
Compliance attestation with IT security standards	- Percentage of IT systems with Compliance attestation on GRC tool	- 50% of IT systems
Increase security of digital environment of DG DEFIS staff	- Percentage of staff moved to WELCOME digital environment	- Staff: 50%
Implementation of the corporate principles for data governance for DG DEFIS key data assets	- Percentage of implementation of the corporate principles for data governance for DG DEFIS key data assets	- Interim milestone: 50%
Increase staff awareness in DG DEFIS on personal data protection rules.	- Percentage of staff attending awareness raising activities.	- Staff: 50%
Map degree of implementation of data protection procedures	- Number of records due. - Number of privacy statements due. - Percentage of Unit inventories	- Percentage of records prepared. - Percentage of privacy statements prepared. - Number of Unit inventories prepared.
DG DEFIS IT systems complying with data protection rules.	- Number of DG DEFIS IT systems.	- Percentage of DG DEFIS IT systems complying with data protection rules.

Objective: DG DEFIS takes account of its environmental impact in its actions and actively promotes measures to reduce the related day-to-day impact of the administration and its work, with the support of its EMAS Correspondents/EMAS Site Coordinators.

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
Paperless working methods at DG level (such as paperless working: e-signatories, financial circuits, collaborative working tools) and staff awareness actions to reduce office paper use in the framework of EMAS corporate campaigns and/or raise awareness about DG/service's office paper use in collaboration with OIB/OIL where appropriate.	- Number of actions - % of staff informed - % of Ares e-signed documents	- 1 action per year - 100 % of DG DEFIS staff informed - Reduce paper consumption (%) with respect to 2022

II. Reducing CO₂, equivalent CO₂ and other atmospheric emissions

Output	Indicator	Target
--------	-----------	--------

Output	Indicator	Target
Staff awareness actions on reducing GHG emissions (such as actions on sustainable commuting during EU Mobility week and VeloWalk corporate events) and/or raise staff awareness on sustainable commuting in collaboration with OIB or OIL (e.g. availability of bike parking facilities, lockers and showers, promote the reduction of parking spaces' use amongst staff).	% of staff informed	- 100% of DG DEFIS staff informed
	% of sustainable commuters (40) at DG/service	Increase % of sustainable commuters at DG/service (%) (41)
Gradual increased use (and number of) Video Conference (VC) meeting rooms for meetings with stakeholders (avoiding business trips) in the DG, in collaboration with DG SCIC, OIB and OIL	Number of VC / hybrid meeting rooms	Number of Video Conference /Hybrid meeting rooms
Analysis of DG's missions trends/patterns (based on corporate EC-staff's professional trips (missions), optimise and gradually reduce CO2 emissions (e.g. by optimising the number of participants in the same mission, promoting more sustainable travelling options, promoting videoconferencing/ virtual events as an alternative).	Number of missions	Optimise number of missions in respect to pre-COVID-19 period
	Means of transportation used	Reduce DG's CO2 emissions from missions (%) in comparison with 2022 data

III. Reducing and management of waste

Output	Indicator	Target
Implementation of the EC Guidelines for sustainable meetings and events, e.g. sustainable catering, reduce/eliminate single-use plastics, gadgets/gifts.	- Number of green events	- At least 1 event

IV. Promoting green public procurement (GPP)

Output	Indicator	Target
--------	-----------	--------

⁽⁴⁰⁾ Sustainable commuting usually refers to environmentally friendly travel modes, such as: public transport (bus, tram, subway, light rail), walking, cycling, and carpooling.

⁽⁴¹⁾ Based on the results of the corporate staff mobility survey conducted by HR.A.4 during 2022.

Output	Indicator	Target
Encourage actions underpinning the use of space data, services and applications in support of the EU Green Deal.	- Number of projects funded - Overall amount in EUR	- Equal or above 2022 results - Equal or above 2022 results

Objective: *DG DEFIS is ensuring a high level of protection of the sensitive and classified information it manages*

Main outputs in 2023:

Output	Indicator	Target
Organise security trainings	Percentage of staff attending awareness online-training session on management of EUCI and on cyber security.	- Management: 40%. - Staff: 80%
Staff security clearance	Percentage of staff with personal security clearance or in the process of being security cleared	- DG DEFIS staff: 95 % ⁽⁴²⁾
Internal security reports	Circulation of quarterly reports	- 4 quarterly reports for management staff
Deployment of RTOP laptop	Number of RTOP deployed in DG DEFIS	- 50 RTOP deployed
Operationalisation of SUE	New DG DEFIS secure area SECOPS, including the use of SEU workstations	Release of new SECOPS in Q1/Q2 2023

⁽⁴²⁾ DG DEFIS statistics exclude trainees. To be noted, as soon as a new staff arrive in DG DEFIS without a personal security clearance, the vetting procedure is immediately launched.